State of Indiana Enterprise Technology Landscape

Strategic Market Intelligence Report

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Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The State of Indiana represents a highly mature, fiscally conservative, yet technologically aggressive enterprise market. As the state navigates the operational realities of early 2026, the executive branch is undergoing a profound strategic recalibration driven by the administration of Governor Mike Braun, who assumed office in January 2025.[1] Transitioning from the foundational modernization initiatives characteristic of former Governor Eric Holcomb's eight-year tenure, the current administration has pivoted the state's focus toward rigorous economic affordability, aggressive private-sector job creation, and the optimization of state operational efficiency.[3] The overarching philosophy dictating state operations under the Braun administration posits that the government must operate with the agility, fiscal discipline, and return-on-investment (ROI) mindset of a commercial enterprise.[3]

Within this macro-political and economic context, enterprise technology is no longer viewed as a passive utility or a mere administrative support function. Instead, the administration recognizes technology—specifically artificial intelligence (AI), automated service delivery, and modernized data infrastructure—as the primary lever for driving down the cost of government while simultaneously elevating the citizen experience.[4] Governor Braun has explicitly identified AI as a cornerstone of Indiana's economic future, actively encouraging data center investments, such as Amazon's recent $15 million facility in Northwest Indiana, while assuring the public that commercial power consumption will not disrupt utility affordability for residents.[4] This pro-technology, pro-efficiency stance creates a highly favorable landscape for original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) and infrastructure providers capable of delivering high-density, energy-efficient, AI-ready compute power to the public sector.

At the epicenter of this technological transformation is the Indiana Office of Technology (IOT), the legislatively mandated enterprise IT provider for all executive branch state agencies.[8] Following a period of transitional leadership in early 2025, IOT is now under the direction of Chief Information Officer Warren Lenard, appointed by Governor Braun in March 2025.[2] Lenard's extensive background as a CIO in the retail and automotive financial services sectors introduces a distinctly commercial approach to public sector IT, leading to intense scrutiny of legacy infrastructure paradigms.[9] The state is actively managing a transition toward cloud-adjacent, hybrid architectures, consumption-based financial models, and robust, enterprise-wide cybersecurity frameworks.[6]

For technology vendors, the Indiana market in 2026 is defined by several immediate, high-value procurement catalysts. The state's primary Quantity Purchase Agreement (QPA) for server infrastructure (QPA 46383) is slated for expiration in June 2026, presenting an imminent opportunity to displace incumbent architectures and redefine the state's hardware standard for the next hardware lifecycle.[13] Furthermore, massive federal funding injections, including an $868 million allocation from the Broadband Equity, Access, and Deployment (BEAD) program and ongoing State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP) allocations, are forcing

infrastructure expansion at both the centralized state core and the municipal edge.[15]

Concurrently, mega-agencies such as the Family and Social Services Administration (FSSA) and the Indiana State Police (ISP) are executing highly complex, federally mandated modernization projects with hard deadlines extending through the end of 2026.[18] This report provides an exhaustive, granular analysis of the Indiana state government's political power structure, IT service delivery models, budgetary flows, and imminent strategic initiatives, culminating in a detailed matrix of actionable whitespaces designed to position enterprise infrastructure portfolios for immediate pipeline generation and sustained revenue capture.

Organization of the Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

The technological trajectory of the State of Indiana is dictated by a concentrated cadre of executive leaders, agency directors, and specialized technologists. The transition from the Holcomb administration to the Braun administration resulted in a significant recalibration of key personnel, bringing private-sector methodologies and personnel to the forefront of state agency management.[2] Understanding the background, operational mandates, and interpersonal interdependencies of these stakeholders is critical for successfully navigating the procurement and strategic alignment processes within the state.

Executive Leadership and the Governor's Office

Governor Mike Braun sets the macro-economic and operational tone for all executive branch agencies. His platform emphasizes that "Indiana is open for business," focusing on driving GDP growth faster than neighboring states like Illinois, Ohio, and Michigan.[4] His administration demands that technology investments yield measurable efficiencies, particularly in areas that interface directly with the public, manage large-scale financial disbursements, or reduce the administrative burden on state employees.[3] The Governor's Office, heavily influenced by the State Budget Agency (SBA), heavily scrutinizes large capital expenditures, requiring clear justification linked to citizen outcomes or systemic operational cost reductions.[21] Aligning technology pitches with the Governor's mandate for affordability and workforce development is non-negotiable for large-scale enterprise engagements.

Centralized IT Authority: Indiana Office of Technology (IOT)

The IOT operates under the legislative authority of Article 13.1 of the Indiana Code, functioning as the central nervous system and enterprise service provider for executive branch technology.[8] The agency employs over 500 IT professionals across more than 40 distinct operational areas, acting as a gatekeeper for architectural standards and procurement.[8]

- **Chief Information Officer (CIO) Warren Lenard:** Appointed in March 2025, Lenard represents a distinct departure from traditional public-sector technocrats.[9] Lenard previously served as the Chief Information Officer for the Byrider automotive dealerships and held executive technology roles at JD Sports Finish Line.[9] His history indicates a deep understanding of high-volume transaction processing, agile software development, and the necessity of organizational culture shifts.[9] He replaces former CIO Tracy Barnes, who stepped down at the conclusion of the Holcomb administration, and interim CIO Jeff Allen.[2] Lenard serves as the President of the Indianapolis Chapter of The Society for Information Management, indicating deep ties to the regional private-sector IT community.[9]

- **Chief Technology Officer (CTO) Dave Fox:** Serving in this role since November 2020, Fox provides crucial institutional memory and architectural continuity for the enterprise.[9] He is responsible for evaluating emerging technologies, developing enterprise standards, and advising on major IT procurements.[9] Fox acts as a key technical gatekeeper; any hardware or software infrastructure introduced into the state data centers must align with the architectural vision he establishes.

- **Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) Hemant Jain:** started at IOT in May 2018 and brought with him more than 23 years of IT, Security, Portfolio/Project Management and Customer Service delivery experience from various industries and sectors. Jain was named State Cybersecurity Leader of the Year in 2019 by StateScoop.

- **Chief Administrative Officer (CAO) Kevin Wilson:** has worked for the state for 13 years and has been in his position at IOT since 2019. Wilson's role is to develop strategies and financial models to ensure IOT delivers cost effective services to IOT partner agencies. The fiscal team is responsible for all of IOT's financial activities including procurement, billing, accounting, budgeting and financial reporting.

- **Chief Operating Officer (COO) Jeff Allen:** A long-tenured IOT veteran who started as a desktop technician in 2006 and rose to COO in 2022, Allen manages the complex day-to-day operations and service delivery mechanics of IOT.[2] Allen served as the acting CIO during the early 2025 gubernatorial transition and intimately understands the intricacies of the state's chargeback billing system and agency relationship management.[2]
- **Director of Communications & External Affairs Graig Lubsen:** Lubsen oversees outward-facing IOT products, manages the state's single sign-on initiatives, and plays a vital role in local government relations.[23] He is heavily involved in the State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP) Planning Committee, driving the "whole-of-state" cybersecurity approach that pushes enterprise security standards down to municipal levels.[24]

Data Strategy and Artificial Intelligence Governance

The Management Performance Hub (MPH) operates as a standalone state agency, officially codified by the 2017 Indiana Open Data Act, serving as the nucleus for state data analytics, privacy, and artificial intelligence governance.[26]

- **Executive Director and Chief Data Officer (CDO) Pete Miller:** Miller leads the MPH and serves as the Chairman of the state's Data Governance Council.[27] He is directly responsible for enforcing the State of Indiana Artificial Intelligence Policy and advancing enterprise data catalog initiatives.[29]
- **Chief Privacy Officer (CPO) Ted Cotterill:** Working in tight coordination with the CDO, the CPO reviews all AI Readiness Assessments submitted by state agencies.[7] The CPO possesses the authority to issue "Exception Grants," which are required before any agency can deploy an AI system, ensuring that ethical and privacy standards are strictly maintained.[30]
- **Director of Data Governance John Stark:** Stark operationalizes the state's data strategy, focusing on ensuring data quality, access management, and the implementation of the enterprise data catalog across disparate agency silos.[28]

Mega-Agency Leadership and Operational Drivers

While IOT manages the underlying infrastructure and MPH governs the data, the actual business requirements, application demands, and funding streams are driven by the state's large cabinet agencies.

- **Family and Social Services Administration (FSSA):** Secretary Mitch Roob, appointed by Governor Braun in January 2025, is a seasoned healthcare executive who previously served as FSSA Secretary from 2005 to 2009.[32] Roob was the principal architect of the original Healthy Indiana Plan and brings immense credibility to the agency's current Medicaid modernization efforts.[32] He is supported by FSSA Chief Information Officer Brian

Arrowood, who oversees the highly complex IT infrastructure required to process billions of dollars in federal and state social safety net disbursements.[33]

- **Indiana Department of Transportation (INDOT):** Commissioner Lyndsay Quist, appointed in March 2025, oversees heavy infrastructure and capital program management.[10] Quist has been with INDOT since 2013 and previously served as the Deputy Commissioner of Capital Program Management.[34] INDOT's technology needs are highly distributed, involving edge computing, geographic information systems (GIS), and massive data collection from statewide road networks to inform intelligent transportation systems.[34]
- **Integrated Public Safety Commission (IPSC):** This commission is governed by a board of local, county, and state public safety officials, currently chaired by Indiana State Police Superintendent Anthony M. Scott.[37] The IPSC oversees the deployment and maintenance of the statewide SAFE-T radio network and is currently driving major IT modernization efforts, including statewide Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) and Records Management Systems (RMS).[19]

IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

The State of Indiana employs a highly centralized IT governance structure paired with a financially distributed consumption model. The Indiana Office of Technology (IOT) does not merely set policy or standards; it actively hosts, manages, procures, and provisions the infrastructure for the entire executive branch, ensuring consolidation that saves the state an estimated $14 million annually by eliminating duplicative technologies.[8]

The Enterprise Chargeback Model and Financial Restructuring

Historically, IOT has operated almost entirely on a strict chargeback methodology, billing individual state agencies for their specific technology consumption.[8] IOT maintains a sophisticated billing system known as PINNACLE, and agencies utilize an IOT Billing Dashboard to audit their monthly charges, identifying over-allocated CPUs, unused virtual machines, or unnecessary database licenses.[8] For Fiscal Year 2026, the baseline chargeback rate for Server Management (Code 1195) is $127.66 per month per server, covering troubleshooting, operating system configuration, and data center management salaries.[8] Rates are evaluated by a third party every three years to ensure they remain competitive with private sector equivalents.[8]

However, this pure chargeback model is currently undergoing structural evolution. IOT leadership has formally recognized that foundational enterprise elements—such as enterprise cybersecurity networks, zero-trust architectures, and baseline connectivity—can no longer be treated as optional services subject to the budgetary whims of individual agencies.[12] Consequently, IOT is actively transitioning toward a blended operating model. Core infrastructure and security will increasingly rely on direct legislative appropriations, while specific compute, storage, and software usage will transition toward highly granular,

consumption-based billing models.[12] This paradigm shift strongly favors infrastructure vendors that can provide "as-a-Service" (aaS) financial models, allowing IOT to map its backend hardware procurement directly to the flexible, consumption-based metrics it offers to its state agency customers.

Technical Architecture, Standardization, and Technical Debt

IOT enforces strict enterprise standards to minimize technical debt and operational fragmentation. The agency utilizes a rigid responsibility matrix (RACI) to define service management boundaries.[8] Any deviation from standard technology requires a formal Exception Form signed by the requesting agency head; however, IOT provides only "best effort" support for non-standard environments, heavily disincentivizing agencies from straying outside the approved infrastructure portfolio.[8]

The state operates sophisticated primary and secondary data centers, utilizing advanced storage architectures like Pure Storage Synchronous Replication to ensure data and processing resources are distributed geographically.[8] This provides a Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of 1.5 to 3.0 hours for critical systems categorized under the "Disaster Recovery Premium" tier.[8]

The state's architecture is increasingly hybrid, balancing on-premises density with targeted public cloud adoption. For instance, the Secretary of State's Office (SOS) recently executed a "lift and shift" migration to Amazon Web Services (AWS) to containerize legacy applications, utilizing a strategy that moves existing applications into modern infrastructure before building advanced analytics around them.[6] Simultaneously, the state legislature has demonstrated an acute awareness of the hidden costs of legacy infrastructure, explicitly funding "Technical Debt Resolution" line items within the state budget to modernize outdated platforms.[39]

Artificial Intelligence Governance Framework

Indiana is a national frontrunner in the implementation of codified, public-sector AI governance. Enacted in February 2024, the State of Indiana Artificial Intelligence Policy is rooted in the National Institute of Standards and Technology's AI Risk Management Framework (NIST AI RMF).[7] This policy fundamentally alters how infrastructure and software are procured for data analytics.

The policy mandates that any state agency seeking to deploy an AI tool must first submit an AI Readiness Assessment Questionnaire to the MPH AI Review Team.[30] This is a rigorous operational hurdle. If an AI system relies on state-owned data, the Chief Data Officer requires a comprehensive enterprise data catalog scan of the source system to ensure data quality and lineage.[29] Furthermore, the policy demands strict contractual controls over external partners to prevent intellectual property leakage, bias, and privacy violations.[7]

The CPO must issue an "Exception Grant" allowing the use of the AI tool.[30] This governance

structure implies a distinct architectural preference for localized, on-premises, or sovereign hybrid-cloud AI infrastructure for sensitive workloads. The risk and compliance burden of pushing highly regulated citizen data (e.g., Medicaid health records, criminal justice information) into multi-tenant public AI models is often deemed unacceptable under the privacy assessments, driving demand for dense, GPU-enabled hardware residing safely within IOT's controlled data center boundaries.

Endpoint Management and the PC Hardware Refresh Lifecycle

IOT strictly manages the state's end-user compute environments through a mandatory, four-year rotating PC Hardware Refresh schedule.[43] This strategy ensures uniform security compliance, simplifies endpoint protection (currently utilizing CrowdStrike deployments), and reduces the administrative burden on support resources.[8] The logistics of this refresh are monumental, affecting approximately 45,000 state-issued devices.[12]

The refresh schedule dictates massive procurement and deployment events. The deployment timeline requires vendors to provide deep supply chain predictability, robust factory-level imaging, and seamless zero-touch provisioning capabilities to ensure IOT technicians are not overwhelmed by manual configuration tasks.

Agency Name	Agency Acronym	Scheduled Refresh Kickoff	Approximate Device Volume
Indiana Veteran's Home	IVH	June 2025	172
Alcohol & Tobacco Commission	ATC	July 2025	100
Indiana Finance Authority	IFA	September 2025	58
Family & Social Services Administration	FSSA	October 2025	2,404
Indiana State Police	ISP	November 2025	1,848
Civil Rights Commission	CRC	January 2026	44
Indiana Housing & Community Development	IHCDA	January 2026	110

Data synthesized from IOT PC Hardware Refresh Schedule & Status [44]

Financials & Budget Breakdown

The State of Indiana operates on a biennial budget cycle, spanning two consecutive fiscal years.[22] The current enacted primary budget bill (House Enrolled Act 1001) covers FY 2026 and FY 2027 (July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2027).[22] The state's fiscal posture is characterized by robust structural balance, significant dedicated reserves, and a conservative approach to debt, allowing for aggressive cash-funded capital investments.[46]

Macro Budgetary Landscape

According to the National Association of State Budget Officers (NASBO) and recent state enactments, Indiana's total spending approaches $51.3 billion annually across all fund types, which include the General Fund, Dedicated State Funds, and Federal Funds.[45] General fund appropriations are enacted at approximately $22.6 billion for FY 2025/2026.[45] The Braun administration successfully passed local property tax cuts and an income tax rate cut tied to future revenue growth, further emphasizing the need for operational efficiency to offset reduced revenue mechanisms.[3]

IOT Appropriations and the Revolving Financial Flow

Because IOT operates predominantly on the aforementioned chargeback model, its direct General Fund appropriations appear deceptively small on the balance sheet, masking the massive operational throughput of the agency.

Direct General Fund appropriations to IOT are primarily limited to specialized statewide functions, such as $5,000,000 annually allocated for IN Mapping Data & Standards (GIS), supplemented by an additional $2,000,000 from a dedicated fund for the same purpose.[47] However, the true financial engine of state IT operations is the "Administration Services Revolving Fund" (TFI-5220-71660).[47] This fund reflects the aggregated chargeback revenue collected from all executive branch state agencies for their consumption of compute, storage, software, and services.

For the FY 2026-2027 biennium, this revolving fund is projected at a staggering **$175,002,483** annually.[47] An additional $21,834,970 is allocated annually for Government Management Information Systems (GMIS) within a parallel revolving structure.[47] This demonstrates the massive purchasing power IOT wields when acting as the consolidated broker for enterprise technology. Furthermore, the state budget specifically allocates $243,000 annually via the Department of Local Government Finance specifically earmarked for "Technical Debt Resolution," indicating a formal legislative strategy to fund the retirement of legacy systems.[39]

Federal Funding Injections: Broadband and Cybersecurity

Beyond standard state revenues, Indiana is currently managing and deploying historic levels of

federal funding that directly necessitate heavy technology infrastructure investments at both the core and the edge.

- **Broadband Equity, Access, and Deployment (BEAD) Program:** Indiana received an $868 million allocation from the NTIA to expand high-speed broadband to unserved and underserved locations.[17] Following the NTIA's approval of Indiana's Initial Proposal Volume 2 in July 2024, the state has moved aggressively into the deployment phase throughout 2025 and 2026.[17] This capital flows to subgrantees—such as local Internet Service Providers (ISPs) and rural cooperatives—requiring massive investments in middle-mile routing, edge data centers, and physical networking infrastructure.[48]
- **State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP):** The United States Department of Homeland Security (DHS) allocated funding to address cyber threats across state and local levels.[15] Indiana's specific FY25 allocation is $1,958,035 out of a total national program of $91.75 million.[16] The Indiana SLCGP Planning Committee utilizes these funds to expand enterprise cybersecurity footprints down to municipal jurisdictions. IOT has successfully leveraged these funds to expand its chosen endpoint protection platform to over 23,000 local government endpoints, managing the threat landscape through a unified monitoring footprint.[12]

FSSA Medicaid and Social Services Budget

The Family and Social Services Administration (FSSA) commands the largest single portion of the state budget, driven by the immense scale of federal matching funds for Medicaid and social safety net programs. For example, Medicaid Assistance (Fund 15050) commands over $4.19 billion annually from the state General Fund, triggering over $7.9 billion in federal matching funds.[52] The sheer volume of this financial flow dictates that the underlying IT systems managing eligibility and disbursement must operate with zero-downtime tolerance, absolute data integrity, and extreme scalability.

Strategic Initiatives & Projects

State agencies are currently executing a series of highly complex, transformational initiatives. These projects are moving past the planning phases and into active implementation, driving immediate demands for compute power, resilient storage arrays, and advanced data analytics platforms.

1. FSSA Integrated Eligibility System Modernization

The Family and Social Services Administration is undergoing a generational modernization of its eligibility and case management systems. Driven by state mandates, operational necessity, and federal compliance requirements, FSSA is fundamentally restructuring how it processes Medicaid, Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), and Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) benefits.[18]

The "Level of Care/eligibility modernization" phase is slated for execution and stabilization throughout 2026.[18] Concurrently, the state is under a strict federal deadline of December 31, 2026, to implement community engagement requirements under the Gateway to Work/BBB parameters, requiring massive changes to systemic logic and citizen portals.[20] This modernization effort requires vast data integration across multiple disparate legacy databases, transitioning the agency toward real-time eligibility verification capabilities.[54] The project utilizes massive independent verification and validation (IV&V) oversight from contractors like Fiserv and PCG, and involves complex data sharing architectures with external financial institutions for automated asset verification.[53] The infrastructure impact is profound: FSSA requires high-transaction database performance, non-disruptive upgrades, and highly secure storage architectures to manage millions of sensitive health records.

2. Project Hoosier SAFE-T & IPSC Next-Gen Communications

The Integrated Public Safety Commission (IPSC) manages the state's mission-critical communications infrastructure for first responders.[37] Under an initiative branded "Project Future," IPSC is executing a complete P25 radio upgrade, a Statewide Computer Aided Dispatch/Records Management System (CAD/RMS) implementation, and Next Generation Cooperative Communications.[19]

In January 2026, IPSC announced a landmark three-year agreement to significantly expand the SAFE-T network, adding the state's 10th simulcast system in Vigo County.[56] Working alongside key partners like Motorola Solutions, the state is densifying the network to eliminate communication dead zones across diverse rural and urban geographies.[56] The technological backend of a statewide CAD/RMS and a simulcast digital radio network requires ruggedized edge servers deployed at remote tower sites, highly resilient centralized data lakes for aggregating criminal justice information, and seamless disaster recovery mirroring to prevent life-safety communication failures.

3. Center of Excellence (CoE) for Low-Code/No-Code Platforms

To accelerate the digitization of agency workflows without linearly scaling internal developer headcount, IOT is establishing a dedicated Platform Center of Excellence (CoE). In February 2026, IOT issued highly strategic Requests for Proposals (RFP 26-86280 and RFP 26-86281) to build a CoE architecture specifically around Salesforce and Microsoft Power Platform.[36]

The stated objective of this initiative is to assist state agencies in building low-code/no-code (LCNC) solutions utilizing best practices, enforcing enterprise governance, and accelerating project delivery for constituent services.[59] This shift decentralizes front-end application development into the hands of agency business analysts but centralizes the underlying data gravity. Consequently, IOT requires highly scalable, API-driven backend storage and compute infrastructure to support the proliferation of these automated workflows.

4. AI and Automation Deployments

Following the establishment of the 2024 AI policy, early adopters within the state government are moving pilot projects into production environments. The Secretary of State's Office (SOS) recently launched two AI-powered chatbots integrated into a modernized AWS cloud backend, demonstrating a successful "lift and shift" containerization strategy that allows legacy databases to interact with modern AI algorithms.[6] Furthermore, the SOS issued an RFP (SOS-26-012) in late 2025 for a Cloud Log Correlation & Security Event Management (SIEM) Platform, requiring high-fidelity, SOC-ready AI and Machine Learning detections for common cyber threats, indicating a push toward automated security response.[60]

Simultaneously, the Management Performance Hub (MPH) continues to refine the Enterprise Data Catalog, actively onboarding agencies into Informatica.[62] This foundational work ensures that state data is clean, well-governed, and fundamentally "AI-ready" for future enterprise deployments, a theme that will dominate the state's "Data Day 2026" conference in April 2026.[63]

Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

Selling enterprise infrastructure into the State of Indiana requires strict adherence to centralized procurement vehicles managed by the Indiana Department of Administration (IDOA), in conjunction with IOT, and absolute compliance with emerging cybersecurity supply-chain standards.

The GovRAMP (Formerly StateRAMP) Mandate

In February 2025, StateRAMP, the influential non-profit cybersecurity verification body headquartered in Indianapolis, officially rebranded to GovRAMP.[64] This rebranding was executed to reflect the organization's mission to unify cybersecurity frameworks across all levels of government, removing the misconception that the standards apply only to state-level executive branches.[64]

This framework serves as the definitive, non-negotiable standard for cloud security in Indiana. Beginning January 1, 2026, the GovRAMP Progressing Snapshot Program introduced stringent new operational requirements ensuring that any vendor placed on the Progressing Product List is actively advancing toward a fully verified status, rather than lingering in a provisional state.[67] Any cloud, Software-as-a-Service (SaaS), or managed infrastructure solution pitched to Indiana agencies must meet these GovRAMP baseline standards. This rigorous compliance requirement significantly extends the procurement cycle for public-cloud adoption, particularly for sensitive workloads. Consequently, this friction frequently shifts the architectural preference back toward traditional on-premises deployments or sovereign private clouds managed entirely within IOT’s secure perimeter.

Quantity Purchase Agreements (QPAs)

The IDOA utilizes Quantity Purchase Agreements (QPAs) to establish competitively bid, multi-year contracts for standard commodities and services, effectively bypassing the need for individual agencies to issue RFPs for standard equipment. For enterprise IT hardware, QPAs dictate the competitive playing field. Outside entities, such as cities and towns, frequently leverage these state-negotiated rates.[14]

QPA Number	Category Description	Expiration Date	Dominant Vendor / Notes
46383	**IT Hardware - Servers**	**June 28, 2026**	**SHI International Corp.** (Multi-manufacturer contract requiring specific discount thresholds) [13]
54976	IT Hardware - Desktops	September 19, 2026	Covers basic electronics, end-user compute, and peripherals [14]
74824	Pure Storage NASPO	June 30, 2028	Direct contract establishing Pure Storage solutions for enterprise arrays [14]
23026	NASPO Computer Equipment	N/A	Heavily leveraged for Dell Direct and via distribution partners like TDSynnex [70]

Note: The impending expiration of QPA 46383 is the most critical infrastructure procurement milestone in the current lifecycle, serving as the primary vehicle for data center compute purchases across the state.

Vendor Ecosystem Dynamics

The state's vendor ecosystem is highly competitive, characterized by a mix of direct OEM relationships and heavy reliance on powerful systems integrators.

- **Pure Storage** currently holds a dominant, direct QPA for specific storage arrays (QPA 74824), which is heavily utilized by IOT to provide synchronous replication and disaster recovery services between the primary and secondary state data centers.[8]
- **Dell Technologies** maintains a massive footprint via NASPO value-point contracts (23026) for both client endpoint devices and enterprise equipment.[70]
- **Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE)** and **Cisco** are frequently leveraged through managed service providers and systems integrators like SHI, Logicalis, and Presidio, which hold extensive multi-state, NASPO, and specialty contracts.[71]
- **CrowdStrike** has cemented its position as the state's chosen vendor for endpoint protection, particularly driven by the SLCGP rollout to local municipal governments.[16]
- **Amazon Web Services (AWS)** is capturing targeted cloud-migration workloads, particularly for agile agencies executing lift-and-shift strategies, though highly regulated agencies remain cautious due to data gravity, exit costs, and GovRAMP friction.[6]

Actionable Dell Opportunities

Based on the synthesis of the Braun administration's political intent, the state's budgetary liquidity, and the specific lifecycles of the underlying infrastructure, Dell Technologies possesses significant whitespace opportunities within the State of Indiana. The following tactical engagements are engineered specifically for the Dell Account Executive team to drive immediate pipeline and long-term architectural lock-in.

1. Capitalize on the QPA 46383 (Servers) Expiration

The Strategic Context: QPA 46383, the state's primary procurement vehicle for server infrastructure currently held by SHI International, expires on June 28, 2026.[13] The IDOA and IOT will be drafting the technical specifications for the successor RFP in early-to-mid 2026. **The Play:** Dell must aggressively position its PowerEdge portfolio—specifically emphasizing AI-ready architectures, liquid cooling efficiency, and high-density compute—as the definitive standard for the new QPA. Governor Braun's mandate for efficiency and the state's growing data center footprint require maximum compute-per-watt metrics. **Action Items:**

- Initiate pre-RFP engagements with CTO Dave Fox to influence the technical specifications. Emphasize how Dell's OpenManage Enterprise suite can integrate seamlessly via API with IOT's chargeback billing system (Pinnacle) to provide highly granular telemetry on power and compute consumption per virtual machine.
- Work tightly with preferred channel partners (or propose a direct bid structure) to ensure Dell is positioned as the anchor OEM of the successor QPA, effectively displacing HPE and locking in the state's compute standard for the next two-to-four-year cycle.

2. Position Dell APEX as the Bridge for IOT's Evolving Financial Model

The Strategic Context: IOT is currently grappling with the operational friction of maintaining a strict historical chargeback model while simultaneously needing to secure foundational, enterprise-wide infrastructure that cannot be billed directly to individual agencies.[8] They are actively seeking to evolve into a consumption-based blend. **The Play:** Pitch Dell APEX (Data Center Utility or Flex on Demand). The APEX financial framework perfectly mirrors IOT's strategic goal of charging agencies based on true consumption while providing IOT with elastic, on-premises infrastructure buffers without requiring massive, upfront capital expenditures (CAPEX) from the general fund. **Action Items:**

- Schedule a strategic briefing focused purely on financial modeling with CIO Warren Lenard and COO Jeff Allen. Lenard's extensive background in retail and automotive finance makes him highly receptive to operational expenditure (OPEX) models that align IT spend directly with business volume. Position APEX as the specific financial mechanism that solves their chargeback dilemma, allowing IOT to provision storage and compute instantly while billing agencies strictly for what they consume.

3. Capture the FSSA Eligibility Modernization Backend

The Strategic Context: FSSA must stabilize its massive Medicaid and SNAP eligibility modernization by the end of 2026 to comply with federal BBB/Gateway to Work mandates.[18] This transition requires vast, high-performance, and deeply resilient database infrastructure capable of handling peak processing loads during redetermination cycles. **The Play:** While Pure Storage holds a footprint at IOT [14], Dell PowerStore and PowerMax offer superior data reduction, native ransomware protection, and deep, seamless integration with VMware and containerized environments. FSSA cannot afford system latency or downtime during citizen eligibility verification. **Action Items:**

- Target FSSA CIO Brian Arrowood.[33] Propose a dedicated, high-performance infrastructure pod (compute plus storage) built specifically for the Eligibility Modernization project. Emphasize isolated security enclaves that simplify compliance with federal tax (IRS 1075) and healthcare (HIPAA) data regulations.
- Highlight Dell's Cyber Recovery Vault to address administrative fears regarding ransomware attacks taking down critical citizen disbursement systems, providing an immutable air gap for state data.

4. Enable "Sovereign AI" to Bypass GovRAMP Cloud Friction

The Strategic Context: The MPH and CDO Pete Miller have unleashed the potential of AI via the February 2024 enterprise policy, but agencies are paralyzed by the immense compliance burden (GovRAMP, data privacy assessments) associated with sending regulated state data to public cloud AI models.[29] **The Play:** Position Dell's "AI-in-a-Box" solutions—such as Dell Validated Designs for Generative AI utilizing NVIDIA architectures—as the fast-track to AI

adoption. By keeping the Large Language Models (LLMs) and the proprietary state data strictly on-premises within IOT's secure data centers, agencies completely bypass the external supply chain risks associated with cloud SaaS, drastically accelerating the CPO exception grant process. **Action Items:**

- Leverage the state's upcoming focus on "Data Day 2026" (Building Indiana's Intelligent Future) scheduled for April 2026.[63] Sponsor, present, or network at MPH events, demonstrating precisely how Dell infrastructure allows agencies like INDOT or FSSA to train localized models on their proprietary data without ever exposing it to the public internet.

5. Dominate the 2025/2026 PC Hardware Refresh

The Strategic Context: IOT executes a rigid, highly choreographed 4-year PC refresh cycle. Over 4,500 endpoints are scheduled for deployment across major agencies (FSSA, ISP, IVH) between late 2025 and early 2026.[44] **The Play:** Dell Client Solutions Group (CSG) must lock in these bulk deployments by demonstrating logistical superiority. **Action Items:**

- Pitch Dell Latitude and OptiPlex fleets equipped with Dell Optimizer (AI-based performance tuning). Move beyond hardware speeds and feeds to emphasize supply chain reliability, factory-level imaging capabilities, and zero-touch provisioning via Windows Autopilot. Demonstrate how Dell can relieve IOT's desktop support technicians of the crippling manual deployment burdens typically associated with massive refresh cycles.

6. Edge Computing for IPSC SAFE-T and BEAD Infrastructure

The Strategic Context: The $868 million BEAD broadband deployment [17] and the IPSC SAFE-T network expansion (which involves statewide CAD/RMS and new radio towers in Vigo, Jay, and Wayne counties) [19] require ruggedized, distributed compute power at the extreme edge of the network. **The Play:** Dell XR series rugged servers are purpose-built for harsh environments (e.g., telecom huts, radio tower base stations, non-climate-controlled edge facilities). **Action Items:**

- Engage INDOT broadband coordinators and IPSC technical architects. Position Dell edge infrastructure as the essential compute layer for the new middle-mile broadband deployments and the foundational hardware for Next-Generation 911 (NG911) and CAD/RMS data processing at the municipal level, ensuring the ultra-low-latency response times demanded by first responders.

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